

Industry News

Worldwide semiconductor sales slowing down

Worldwide semiconductor revenue has slowed down in 2011 and the market is on pace to have \$299 billion revenue in total—a decline of 0.1 per cent from 2010, according to market research firm Gartner, Inc.

“Three key factors are shaping the short-term outlook: excess inventory, manufacturing overcapacity and slowing demand due to economic weakness. Semiconductor companies’ third-quarter guidance is well below seasonal averages. The supply chain is also showing significant slowdown, and semiconductor-related inventory levels are still elevated,” said Bryan Lewis, research vice president at Gartner.

97 per cent smartphones to have touchscreens by 2016

According to an ABI Research report, over the next five years touchscreens will be as pervasive in smartphones as Wi-Fi chipsets, reaching 97 per cent of all smartphones by 2016.

Smartphones with touchscreens have gone up from just 7 per cent of the total smartphone volume in 2006 to 75 per cent in 2010, and the touchscreen was a key driver to the smartphone market which grew more than 325 per cent over that period.

The screen and touch technologies will continue to evolve, and are expected to further reshape the market for other mobile devices as well.



Steve Jobs resigns as Apple CEO

Chief executive and founder of Apple Inc., Steve Jobs, has resigned due to health-related problems. Tim Cook, previously Apple's chief operating officer, will replace the 55-year-old Jobs as CEO. Cook, 50, joined Apple in 1998 and was appointed the COO in 2004.

AMD appoints new CEO

Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) has appointed Rory Read, a top executive at Lenovo, as its new chief executive officer (CEO). Read was the president and had also served as chief operating officer at Lenovo. His key role at AMD would be to make the company a key player in developing chips for mobile devices.

ELCINA elects new executive committee

ELCINA Electronic Industries Association of India (ELCINA) at its annual general meeting has elected its new executive committee for 2011-12. T.